

group of works, which you may or may not be able to access. Examples include abstracts and conference papers.

7. You can filter through your results by author name.

It can sometimes be difficult to search for a particular paper, because of things such as author initials, and so on. Just click on the Advanced Search link near the top of the search bar: this page also gives you Advanced Search tips. The fields are pretty self-explanatory, in the literal sense that there's an explanation to each of them—naturally, we don't need to go into that here!

There's also the option, on the main page, to only search recent articles.

Coverage in Google Scholar is strongest in science and technology. In addition, remember that not *all* results are “scholarly”—meaning that if you want to cite a source in a work of yours, don't say “I got it from Google Scholar” as a defence of the “scholarliness” of the work you're citing!

What Do I Get?

Don't expect all articles to be available for reading on the Web! Like we said, some are available from the British Library for a fee. Some results, when clicked, will take you to places such as the ACM (Association for Computing Machinery) portal, where you need a membership to be able to read the article. Abstracts are almost always readable off the results page at some place or the other, and in some cases, like we said, the full text of the article might be available online.

Some results link to books, and they aren't clickable—you need to click the “group of” link. This will take you to the book results, which, of course, demands that you whip out your wallet, wherever it is that it takes you.

We'd suggest a subscription to ACM.org, the IEEE Web site (www.ieee.org), and other such places, because there's such a

huge store of papers available at these sites. Unfortunately, you can't purchase individual articles from either ACM or the IEEE—you need to be a member.

On the plus side, you get some results from books.google.com, which we've discussed elsewhere.

What Are “Scholarly Articles”?

If you haven't ever searched for a scholarly article for research, we should tell you a little bit about them. Many of them tend to be inaccessible to those without the appropriate background, and a problem is that a typical “scholarly” paper doesn't mention what background is required.

To elaborate a little, here are snippets from two articles we found on the Web using Google Scholar. The search term was “DDR memory.”

Here's from the introduction of one of the results, *DDR2 and low latency variants*, by B Davis, T Mudge, B Jacob, and V Cuppu:

The expanding performance gap between processor speeds and primary memory speeds has been characterized as a “memory wall.” Until recently this problem has been attacked by designing the CPU to tolerate long memory latencies, examples include: prefetching, out-of-order execution, lock-up free caches, speculative loads, data prediction, and memory-request reordering. Now, we are beginning to see significant changes to DRAM architecture in an attempt to improve both the bandwidth and the latency of the primary memory system from the other side of the “wall.” Most of these approaches...

Here's from the abstract of another article: by T Kirihata, G Mueller, B Ji, G Frankowsky, and J M Ross (hold your breath)!

A 390-mm², 16-bank, 1-Gb, double-data-rate (DDR) synchronous dynamic random access memory (SDRAM) has been fabricated in fully planarized 0.175-μm, 8F2 trench cell technology. The 1-Gb SDRAM employs a hybrid bit-